

The price of authority

You're all well aware we've all been consumed by Baldur's Gate 3 at the moment. Me especially (soon™ approaching that 300 hour mark). We've even got the review in this issue of the magazine, so be sure to check that out. Understandably, no one can stop singing the game's praises. What Larian has achieved here is nothing short of remarkable. However, the success of this ambitious project has had a bit of a storm brewing in the game development community.

The credit for Baldur's Gate 3's success primarily goes to Larian Studios. They embarked on this ambitious project after their previous triumph with Divinity: Original Sin 2. What sets Larian Studios apart is their dedication to perfection; a luxury few game developers can afford in today's fast-paced industry.

It's crucial to recognise that Baldur's Gate 3 wasn't without its risks. The time, effort, and resources invested in this massive undertaking could have spelled doom for a smaller studio if the game hadn't achieved the success it did. Larian Studios took a leap of faith, worked tirelessly, and showcased a level of professionalism that's now being held as the gold standard for future RPGs. The game is a testament to what dedicated developers can achieve when they are given time and resources. What we can't ignore is that Larian's achievements come with a whole new set of burdens for the entire industry.

The success of Baldur's Gate 3 has undoubtedly raised expectations within the industry to new heights. Game developers are facing mounting pressure to meet the

standards set by this monumental release. Many studios grapple with the demands of publishers who push for early releases. Games like Cyberpunk 2077 and Pokémon Scarlet & Violet, while highly anticipated, suffered from disastrous launches marred by performance issues that couldn't be resolved within their tight schedules. Inevitably, Baldur's Gate 3 will serve as a reference point for future role-playing games, and that is a reality that can't be avoided.

Gamers have every right to expect quality when they spend their hard-earned cash on a game. However, while the game offers countless lessons for the industry to consider, I don't know if Baldur's Gate 3's excellence should be used as an exclusive yardstick for all games.

I still think other role-playing games should be evaluated on their own merits. Baldur's Gate 3 will cast an ever-looming shadow on the genre, but we should keep in mind that not every game needs to emulate its scale. After all, this industry thrives on diversity.

Let me know your thoughts at editor@skoar.in. *



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